

May 21, 1973

President Kingman Brewster
Yale University
Woodbridge Hall
105 Wall Street
New Haven, Conn. 06520

Dear Dr. Brewster:

I have been contacted by Mr. Eduardo Padro, Chairman of the student organization called Despierta Boricua. In his correspondence, he has indicated that the organization has requested that you implement a Puerto Rican Studies Dept. at Yale. I wish to add my voice of strong support in favor of such a project. Wherever it has been implemented - Brooklyn College, Hunter, Fordham and Livingston College, it has been a tremendous success and has broadened the educational perspectives for Puerto Rican students and very often of non-Puerto Rican students as well.

A second point is the students' request for a Puerto Rican Assistant Dean. Here too, our experience has been that the hiring of Puerto Rican faculty and staff has proven to be of immeasurable assistance to Puerto Rican students in their attempt to negotiate their education with the university.

I trust that you will accord full consideration to the students' request and respond to their needs to the utmost extent feasible. Should you or any member of your staff require any additional information or consultation, please do not hesitate to call on me.

Cordially,

Luis Nieves
Dean of Student Affairs

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